

**2 February 1943****DEFEAT AT STALINGRAD**

Nazi invasion forces embarked on one of history's most destructive battles in an attempt to take Stalingrad, an important communications centre in the southern USSR. They were forced to surrender after five months' fighting. The loss drained German manpower from other fronts and helped turn the tide of the war.



▷ Soviet brass medal for the defence of Stalingrad

▽ An Allied soldier comforts an Italian baby

**July 1943****ALLIED FORCES INVADE ITALY**

Starting with a six-week campaign to capture Sicily, Allied forces fresh from victory in North Africa crossed over to mainland Italy to take the war into the Axis heartland. By early October, they had won control of the south of the country. Their passage northward was bitterly contested, and the final German surrender did not take place until 2 May 1945.

1943

**8 February 1943 Indian and British** special forces begin a guerrilla campaign against the Japanese in Burma

**12 July 1943 German forces retreat** at Kursk after the largest tank battle in history

**August-September 1944**  
**Advancing Allied forces** liberate Paris and Brussels

**6 June 1944****OPERATION OVERLORD**

As the war swung in favour of the Allies, their commanders ordered the "D-Day" landings on the Normandy coast as the first step in a large-scale offensive to win back German-occupied western Europe. Once successfully established ashore, the Allied forces – eventually some three million strong – drove eastward, crossing the Rhine to enter Germany itself in March 1945.

◁ **Allied forces** establish a beach-head in Normandy

